

ECON 100B — Topics, Priorities, and Workload Plan

Topics, Priorities, and Workload Plan

1. Course information

- **Course:** Economics 100B — Macroeconomics
- **Instructor:** Ryan D. Edwards
- **Textbook:** Charles I. Jones, *Macroeconomics* (6th ed., Norton). Lectures map directly to Jones chapters.
- **Final exam: Mon May 11, 2026 — 3:00–4:30 PM PT — Pimentel 1 (90 minutes)**
 - In-person, written. Short-answer + problems + (separate) take-home essay (essay is 10% of grade, written at home — not part of the in-person 90 min).
 - Closed-book; cheat sheet allowed for midterm — confirm same for final on bCourses.
 - Final exam = 25% of grade. Lowest PS dropped.
 - Two old finals on Drive: Spring 2011 (120 min), Spring 2014 (also `econ201-final-s14*.pdf` in your folder).
- **Core idea (one sentence):** Build mathematical models of the long-run economy (Solow / ideas) and the short-run economy (IS curve, Phillips curve, monetary and fiscal stabilization policy), then apply them to actual macroeconomic episodes (financial crises, exchange rates, government debt).
- **Format note:** Cumulative final, but Edwards's final-review slide emphasizes class 17 was the midterm coverage point — so post-midterm material (classes 18–25) tends to be weighted higher on the final, with foundational pre-midterm material still in scope as a baseline.

2. Topics — every class in the semester

The slide deck filename gives the class number; titles below are extracted from the actual page-1 of each PDF. Each class is roughly 80 minutes of lecture material.

Pre-midterm material (Classes 1–17)

#	Class	Jones ch	Topic / main idea
01	Introduction	—	Course logistics, why macro, intro examples. Pure setup.
02	Measuring the Macroeconomy	2	GDP and NIPA, real vs nominal GDP, GDP deflator, CPI, inflation indices, unemployment rate definitions.
03	The Long Run	3	Big-picture: cross-country income differences, the "growth miracle" question, what determines living standards over decades.
04	A Model of Production 1	4	Cobb–Douglas production function, factor markets, labor share. Setting up the framework.
05	A Model of Production 2	4	Solving the production model, total factor productivity, accounting for income differences across countries.
06	The Solow Model 1	5	Capital accumulation equation, depreciation, savings rate. The " $k_{t+1} = sf(k) + (1-d)k_t$ " framework.
07	The Solow Model 2	5	Steady state, dynamics, comparative statics (savings rate change, depreciation change).
08	The Solow Model 3	5	Golden rule level of capital, transition dynamics, Solow with population/tech growth.

#	Class	Jones ch	Topic / main idea
09	Growth and Ideas 1	6	Endogenous growth, ideas as non-rival, Romer model intuition.
10	Growth and Ideas 2	6	Romer model formal solution, balanced growth path, idea production.
11	Growth and Ideas 3	6	Combining Solow + Romer, growth accounting, what explains long-run growth differences.
12	The Labor Market	7	Bathtub model of unemployment, frictional vs structural vs cyclical, wage rigidity, Beveridge curve.
13	Inflation	8	Quantity theory, Fisher equation $i = r + \pi^e$, hyperinflation, real vs nominal interest rates.
14	The Short Run	9	Short-run vs long-run distinction, output gap, business cycles overview.
15	Recent and Not-so-recent Macro-clysms	10	Case studies: 2008 GFC, COVID-19 recession, Great Depression, stagflation.
16	The IS Curve [1/2]	11	Deriving IS curve from goods-market identity, marginal product of capital, real interest rate effect on output.
17	The IS Curve [2/2]	11	Using IS curve, shocks, fiscal policy via IS shifts. Midterm coverage ended here.

Post-midterm material (Classes 18–25 + final review) — likely heavier weighting on final

#	Class	Jones ch	Topic / main idea
18	Monetary Policy & the Phillips Curve [1/2]	12	MP curve (Fed sets real rate), Phillips curve (π and unemployment trade-off), expectations-augmented form.
19	Monetary Policy & the Phillips Curve [2/2]	12	Combining IS-MP-PC, Taylor rule, inflation expectations dynamics.
20	Stabilization policy [1/2]	13	AD/AS framework, demand vs supply shocks, response of policy.
21	Stabilization policy [2/2]	13	Optimal monetary response, sacrifice ratio, lessons from Volcker disinflation.
22	Financial Crises + Government	14, 18	2008-style mechanics, leverage, lender-of-last-resort, intro to government balance sheet.
23	Government	18	Government budget constraint, debt-to-GDP dynamics $B_{t+1}/Y = (1+r)/(1+g) \cdot B_t/Y + (G-T)/Y$, debt sustainability, primary deficit.
24	International Trade	19	Trade in goods, comparative advantage at the macro level, current account basics.
25	Exchange Rates & International Finance	20	Real vs nominal exchange rate, interest rate parity, Mundell-Fleming intuition, capital flows.
FR	Final Review	—	Edwards's own walkthrough — read this last as a roadmap.

You also have class17mt.pdf — that's the midterm review, useful only as a checklist of what's been previously tested.

3. Priority list

Three tiers. Within each tier, items are ranked by exam likelihood $\times$ my expected payoff per study hour.

TIER 1 — HIGH (do these first, allocate ~60% of ECON 100B time)

These are the workhorses of any 100B final. They appear on essentially every Jones-textbook-aligned final, often as the largest single problem.

1. **Solow Model (Classes 06–08, Ch 5).** Steady-state derivation, golden rule, comparative statics, transition dynamics. Multi-part algebra problem near-guaranteed. *Exam likelihood: ~95%.*
2. **IS Curve (Classes 16–17, Ch 11).** Deriving IS from goods market, fiscal/MPC shifts, shock analysis. Foundation for all short-run questions. *Exam likelihood: ~85%.*
3. **Monetary Policy + Phillips Curve (Classes 18–19, Ch 12).** MP curve, expectations-augmented Phillips, Taylor rule, inflation dynamics. **Post-midterm + central $\rightarrow$ very high weighting.** *Exam likelihood: ~90%.*
4. **Stabilization Policy / IS-MP-PC together (Classes 20–21, Ch 13).** Demand vs supply shocks, optimal policy response, sacrifice ratio. **Post-midterm capstone synthesis.** *Exam likelihood: ~80%.*
5. **Government debt dynamics (Class 23, Ch 18).** Debt-to-GDP equation, sustainability, r vs g comparison. Algebra-heavy, easy points if practiced. *Exam likelihood: ~70%.*

TIER 2 — MEDIUM (do after Tier 1; ~30% of time)

Likely on the exam, but as smaller short-answer items rather than centerpieces.

6. **Production model (Classes 04–05, Ch 4).** Cobb–Douglas, TFP, factor shares. Cumulative baseline; usually 1 question. *Exam likelihood: ~60%.*
7. **Growth and Ideas / Romer (Classes 09–11, Ch 6).** Non-rival ideas, balanced growth path. Conceptually rich, less algebra. *Exam likelihood: ~55%.*
8. **Inflation (Class 13, Ch 8).** Fisher equation, real vs nominal rates, quantity theory. Definitions cold = guaranteed points. *Exam likelihood: ~70% (small).*
9. **Financial Crises (Class 22, Ch 14).** Conceptual / case-study. Likely a short essay-style question. *Exam likelihood: ~50%.*
10. **Labor Market (Class 12, Ch 7).** Bathtub model, frictional/structural distinction. Possibly 1 short question. *Exam likelihood: ~40%.*

TIER 3 — LOW (only after Tiers 1–2; ~10% of time, mostly skim-level)

Conceptual or context material; low yield per hour, but skim so you're not blindsided.

11. **Macroeconomic measurement (Class 02, Ch 2).** GDP, CPI, deflator definitions. Just memorize definitions. *Exam likelihood: ~50% but trivial.*
12. **Long-run intro (Class 03, Ch 3).** Cross-country income differences. Mostly motivation. *Exam likelihood: ~30%.*
13. **The Short Run intro (Class 14, Ch 9).** Conceptual setup for IS-MP. Folded into Tier 1 questions. *Exam likelihood: 30% but covered in Tier 1.*
14. **Macro-clysms case studies (Class 15, Ch 10).** Pure narrative — only useful as illustrations on the take-home essay, not the in-person final. *Exam likelihood: ~20%.*
15. **International trade + exchange rates (Classes 24–25, Ch 19–20).** Recent material BUT not historically central to Edwards's final exams. **Risk-flag:** check Spring 2014 and Spring 2011 finals to see how much weight he gives the international material — if heavy, bump these to Tier 2. *Exam likelihood: ~40% (uncertain — verify against past exam).*
16. **Introduction (Class 01).** Skip. *Exam likelihood: ~5%.*

What to drop entirely if time-constrained

- `class17mt.pdf` (midterm review of already-passed material)
- `class20pollev.pdf` (poll-everywhere version of class 20 — same content)
- Take-home essay drafts (separate deliverable, not the in-person final)

4. Summary, workload anticipation, and time-allocation advice

Concise summary

ECON 100B has a clean modular structure: it's six sets of 3-class modules (Solow, Romer, IS-MP-PC, Stabilization, Crises/Government, International). Each module has a small set of equations to know cold, and a small set of questions Jones-aligned exams reuse heavily. It's the most predictable of your four finals — the question types from Spring 2014 will preview what's coming.

Anticipated review workload (honest estimate)

- Total hours genuinely needed for a comfortable A-level performance, *given* you attended class and did the PSs: **15–20 hours**.
- The current master plan allocates **13 hours in the 5-day window + 4 hours on May 9 (buffer) + ~1 hour Mon morning ≈ 18 hours**. This is in the right ballpark.
- **Calibration risk:** if you mostly tracked the math through the semester, 18 hrs is plenty. If you fell behind on Solow/Romer/IS-MP derivations, you'll feel pressed and may need to steal 2–3 hours from CS 61A/61B.

Hour-by-hour suggested split within those 18 hours

Activity	Hours	Why
Re-derive Solow steady state + golden rule from scratch	2	The single most-tested topic.
Re-derive IS curve from goods-market identity	1.5	Foundation.
Work through MP + Phillips curve + Taylor rule on paper	2.5	Post-midterm centerpiece.
Stabilization policy: 3 different shock-scenarios in IS-MP-PC	2	Synthesis practice.
Debt dynamics algebra: 3 worked problems with different r - g cases	1.5	Mechanical points.
Take Spring 2014 final timed (90 min) + grade yourself	2	Highest single-activity yield. Do this on Day 4.
Review the 2014 mistakes; re-derive what you missed	1	Targeted gap-fill.
Take Spring 2011 final timed	2	Different format (120 min) but same content.
Final-review slide walkthrough + class17mt checklist	1	Edwards's own roadmap.
Handwritten cheat sheet — definitions + key equations	1.5	Writing it IS review.
Buffer / weakest-topic re-drill	1	Always need this.

Time-allocation advice — adjustments to the master plan

The master plan's 13 hr in 5 days is reasonable, but I want to flag three calibrations:

17. **Day 4 (Thu May 7) timed past-final must happen.** No exceptions. This is the single highest-yield activity for ECON 100B and it's the only one I cannot replicate by reading.

18. **If you've been weak on the Solow algebra all semester**, push 2 hours of Day 1 from "general review" specifically to deriving Solow on a blank sheet 3 times. Mechanical fluency matters under 90-minute time pressure.
19. **If after Day 4's timed exam you score below ~65%**, re-allocate 2 hours from CS 61A's Day 5 block (3 hr) into ECON 100B that evening. CS 61A has the most slack of the four (your existing study guides are very strong), so it's the natural cushion source.

What NOT to do (anti-advice)

- Don't spend more than 1 hour on `class15.pdf` (Macro-clysms). It's interesting but low-yield for the in-person final.
- Don't memorize the take-home essay topic — that's a separate exam.
- Don't try to read all 28 slide decks linearly. Use the priority tiers above.
- Don't write your cheat sheet at the last minute on May 10 — start writing it Day 5 (Fri May 8) so the act of writing reinforces memory across the weekend.